# MOZZARELLA DI BUFALA CAMPANA PDO

## THE BASICS



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| MAKE: | Soft |
| SUB MAKE: | Fresh or Unripened cheese: lactic or rennet set |
| POST-MAKE: | Wrapped, Rolled or Processed |
| SUB POST-MAKE: | Pasta filata |
| TYPICAL AGE PROFILE: | one week |
| APPROXIMATE WEIGHT(S): | Various shapes and sizes |
| GEOGRAPHICAL ORIGIN: | Campania, Italy |
| PROTECTED STATUS: | PDO - must be made in Caserta and Salerno provinces, or parts of Benevento, Naples, Frosinone, Latina and Rome |
| SPECIES OF MILKING ANIMAL: | Buffalo |
| BREED OF BUFFALO: | Italian Mediterranean |
| RAW/PASTEURISED MILK: | Examples of both depending on cheesemaker |
| VEGETARIAN/ANIMAL RENNET: | Typically animal rennet |
| COMMONLY ENCOUNTERED VARIATIONS: | smoked (affumicato) |

## THE STORY

Mozzarella is made all over the world from buffalo and cows' milk, but it is Mozzarella di Bufala Campana from central-southern Italy that is widely prized above all else. Buffalo were introduced to the region in the 7th century to work in the marshes and the first mention of the cheese came in the 12th century. It was originally called mozza, from the word mozzare – to lop off – a reference to the pasta filata 'pulled curd' process.

Mozzarella is classified as a soft cheese, but it has much in common with hard cheese. The milk is heated to 33-39°C and the curd set with rennet. This is cut and stirred and the curds allowed to acidify. Near-boiling water is added to melt them into a solid mass, which is pulled and spun, before pieces of cheese are 'lopped off' and shaped into balls. They are salted in brine and packed in acidified water.

## THE CHARACTER

Mozzarella's texture should be elastic, with a tight, smooth surface. There should be no yellowish marks or spots, and, when pressed, the texture should be neither soft nor rubbery. When you slice into mozzarella, droplets of milky whey should seep out and it should have a grainy surface with layers, like an onion, especially near the surface. Sweet, dairy notes predominate.

### PERFECT PARTNERS:

One of the world's great cooking cheeses, mozzarella is used in salads and melted on pizzas, but also works on its own with the red fruit notes of rosé.

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